

Current Affairs

The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi approved the Terms of Reference (ToR) for the 8th Central Pay Commission on 28 October 2025. Former Supreme Court judge Ranjana Prakash Desai was named as the chairperson of the 8th Pay Commission by the Centre. Petroleum secretary Pankaj Jain as member secretary and IIM Bangalore professor Pulak Ghosh as part-time member of this commission.



Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) and Russia's United Aircraft Corporation (PJSC-UAC) signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to jointly produce the SJ-100 civil commuter aircraft in India. The agreement was signed in Moscow on 28 October 2025.



➤ The SJ-100 is a twin-engine, narrow-body aircraft currently operated by more than 16 commercial airlines.

The Indian Army has signed a contract for the procurement of its first indigenously designed and manufactured Software Defined Radios (SDR), developed by Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and produced by Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) on 28 October 2025.

The 8th Session of the International Solar Alliance (ISA) Assembly has begun at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on 27 October 2025. 124 countries participated and over 40 Ministers from across the globe attended the session. The event concludes on 30 October 2025.

The IAF has made history by becoming the first non-NATO nation to participate in Exercise Ocean Sky 2025. This air combat drill hosted by the Spanish Air Force at Gando Air Base, Spain, from October 20 - 31, 2025.



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Prime Minister Narendra Modi virtually participated in the 47th ASEAN Summit 2025 on 26 October 2025. This was



Prime Minister's 12th participation in the India-ASEAN Summit. In his address, Prime Minister congratulated Timor Leste on becoming the 11th Member of ASEAN.

♦ Malaysia, as the Chair of ASEAN, hosting the Summit and Related Summits under the theme "Inclusivity and Sustainability" at the Kuala Lumpur Convention Centre (KLCC). The summit concludes on 28 October 2025.

Independent left-wing politician Catherine Connolly was elected Ireland's 10th president after a landslide victory. She defeated her rival Heather Humphreys. A seasoned politician and political performer, Connolly has been Member of Parliament since 2016 for the Galway West constituency and also served as Deputy Speaker of the Irish Parliament.



A bust of Nobel Laureate Rabindranath Tagore was unveiled at the Indian Embassy in Beijing on 26 October 2025. The sculpture has been carved by the famous Chinese sculptor Yuan Xikun.

The Union government has announced Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2025 on 25 October 2025. Eminent physicist Jayant Vishnu Narlikar has posthumously been selected for the Vigyan Ratna Puraskar. Eight scientists have been selected for the Vigyan Shree award. Under the Vigyan Yuva category, 14 young scientists have been selected across various disciplines, while the Vigyan Team award is being given to Team Aroma Mission CSIR for its contributions in Agricultural Science.



State Bank of India (SBI) has received global recognition for its innovation and customer-centric approach, securing two prestigious honours from New York-based Global Finance magazine - the 'World's Best Consumer Bank 2025' and the 'Best Bank in India 2025'. The



awards, presented during the World Bank and International Monetary Fund (IMF) annual meetings, underscore SBI's leadership in digital banking, financial inclusion, and customer excellence.

Indian-American security expert Paul Kapur was officially sworn in as the Assistant Secretary of State for the Bureau of South and Central Asian Affairs in the Trump administration. He was among 107 nominees approved by the Senate and will now lead America's diplomatic engagement with key South and Central Asian nations, including India.

Indian Coast Guard (ICG) has launched two advanced Fast Patrol Vessels ICG Ship Ajit and ICG Ship Aparajit at Goa Shipyard Limited on 24 October 2025. The new 52-metre-long vessels are the seventh and eighth in a series of eight indigenously built Fast Patrol Vessels.

The International Monetary Fund (IMF) has projected that India's economy will expand by 6.6 percent in 2025-26, according to its latest World Economic Outlook (WEO) report. IMF has also predicted that India will continue to be one of the fastest-growing 'emerging market and developing economies'.

Prathiba M Singh, a judge of the Delhi High Court was named Chair of the World Intellectual Property Organisation (WIPO) Advisory Board of Judges for its 2025-27 term. She was elevated as a permanent judge of the Delhi High Court in 2017. She also served as the Chairperson and Presiding Judge of the Delhi High Court's first-ever Intellectual Property Division during 2021-22.



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Sanae Takaichi has become the Japan's first female Prime Minister on 21 October 2025. She is the leader of Japan's ruling Liberal Democratic Party (LDP). Takaichi received 125 votes in the Upper House, just one vote above the simple majority necessary for victory. Earlier, she secured 237 votes in the Lower House, exceeding the required majority of 233.



Syndrel Das and Divyanshi Bhowmick have made history by claiming the No.1 spot in the latest ITTF Under-19 Girls' Doubles World Rankings, released on 21 October 2025. The Indian duo lead with 3,910 points, ahead of Chinese Taipei's Wu Jia-En/Wu Ying-Syuan (3,195) and France's Leana Hochart/Nina Guo Zheng (3,170).



● In another first for Indian table tennis, six Indian girls have broken into the top 100 of the world doubles rankings.

Ministry of Civil Aviation said that the Regional Connectivity Scheme - Ude Desh Ka Aam Nagrik (UDAN) has facilitated over 1.56 crore passengers through 3.23 lakh flights in nine years. UDAN scheme was launched on 21st October 2016 under the National Civil Aviation Policy.

India has developed its first indigenously discovered antibiotic, Nafithromycin, marking a significant milestone in the country's pursuit of self-reliance in the pharmaceutical and biotechnology sectors. The antibiotic, effective against resistant respiratory infections, is particularly beneficial for cancer patients and those with poorly controlled diabetes.



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh inaugurated the third production line of the HAL Tejas Mk1A Light Combat Aircraft and the second production line of the HAL HTT-40 trainer aircraft at the Nashik facility of Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) on 17 October 2025. He also flagged off the first Tejas Mk1A manufactured at the new line, hailing it as a major step toward strengthening India's defence manufacturing capabilities.



The Indian Navy inducted its 11th Ammunition Cum Torpedo Cum Missile Barge LSAM 25 (Yard 135) at an induction ceremony held at the Naval Dockyard, Mumbai on 17 October 2025. The contract for the construction and delivery of eleven ACTCM Barges was signed with Suryadipta Projects Pvt Ltd, Thane, on March 5, 2021.

On 16 October 2025, India and Brazil agreed to significantly expand their existing trade agreement between India and the MERCOSUR bloc, aiming to enhance bilateral trade and investment. The understanding was reached during a meeting held in New Delhi between Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal and Vice President of Brazil and Minister of Development, Industry, Trade and Services Geraldo Alckmin.

India was elected as the Co-Chair of the Regional Committee of United Nations Global Geospatial Information Management for Asia and the Pacific (UN-GGIM-AP). India was represented in the election by Hitesh Kumar S. Makwana, IAS, Surveyor General of India.



India and Mongolia inked ten MoUs following bilateral and delegation level between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Mongolian President Khurelsukh Ukhnaa in New Delhi on 14 October 2025. The MoUs are for cooperation in



Humanitarian aid, restoration of heritage site in Mongolia, cooperation in immigration, geology and mineral resources, promotion of Cooperatives, and sharing of digital solutions.

India has been elected unopposed to the Human Rights Council for the seventh time for a three-year term (2026-28) starting next year. The Human Rights Council is the main UN body with 47 members. It promotes and protects human rights around the world, reviews the situation in member countries, and provides a forum to discuss issues.

Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL) in Visakhapatnam was granted Mini-Ratna status by the Government of India on 14 October 2025. The recognition follows the shipyard's consistent financial performance, and operational improvements over the past few years.

♦ Established in 1941, HSL has been a cornerstone of India's ship-building capability, supporting India's naval and commercial fleets.

The 4th edition of India-Australia joint military exercise, AUSTRAHIND-2025, commenced at Irwin Barracks, Perth, Australia on 13 October 2025. The exercise, being held from October 13 to 26, seeks to enhance interoperability, joint planning, and execution capabilities between the two armies across diverse operational environments.

♦ The Indian Army contingent is being led by a Battalion of Gorkha Rifles along with troops from other arms and services.



Indian batter Smriti Mandhana became the first ever player to score 1000 or more runs in Women's ODIs in a calendar year. She scripted the history during Women's ODI World Cup match against Australia in Vishakapatnam on 12 October 2025. She also completed 5,000 runs in women's ODIs, becoming only the fifth and second Indian batter after Mithali Raj to achieve the feat.



Kaziranga National Park field director Dr. Sonali Ghosh becomes first Indian to win IUCN Kenton Miller Award. She received the prestigious award for innovation in National Parks



and Protected Area Sustainability at the IUCN World Conservation Congress, held in Abu Dhabi on 10 October 2025.

Actor Deepika Padukone has been appointed as the first-ever Mental Health Ambassador of the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW). The step by the ministry will promote a more sup-



portive mental health ecosystem in the country. With this collaboration, the actor aims to contribute to strengthening the nation's mental health framework, building on the significant strides India has made in prioritising mental well-being.

India launched its National Red List Roadmap and Vision 2025–2030 at the IUCN World Conservation Congress 2025. The event, held at the Asia Pavilion, witnessed the official unveiling by Union Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Kirti Vardhan Singh.



Hungarian Author Laszlo Krasznahorkai wins Nobel Prize For Literature 2025. Krasznahorkai has been awarded "for his compelling and visionary oeuvre that, in the midst of apocalyptic terror, reaffirms the power of art". The laureate receives a medal, diploma, and monetary award, and the official ceremony takes place on 10 December 2025 in Stockholm.



Linthoi Chanambam wins India's first-ever medal at Judo Junior World Championships. She grabbed a bronze medal in women's 63 kg category with a win over Netherland's Joni Gelien. This is her second medal in a world event after she bagged a gold in the world Cadet Championships in 2022.



The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has launched a retail sandbox for its Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) on October 8, 2025. A sandbox is a controlled environment where new technologies can be safely tested without affecting the broader financial system. It is marking a significant development in India's evolving digital financial ecosystem.



California has officially recognised the Diwali festival as a state holiday. It has now become the third state in the United States of America, after Pennsylvania and Connecticut, which declare Diwali as a state holiday.



United States based scientists John Clarke, Michel H. Devoret and John M. Martinis won the 2025 Nobel Prize in Physics for research into quantum mechanical tunneling. The winners carried out experiments in the mid-1980s with an electronic circuit built of superconductors and demonstrated that quantum mechanical properties could be made concrete on a much larger, macroscopic scale.



♦ It is the 119th time the prize has been awarded. Last year (2024), artificial intelligence pioneers John Hopfield and Geoffrey Hinton won the physics prize for helping create the building blocks of machine learning.

The 7th meeting of the India-Brazil Trade Monitoring Mechanism (TMM) was held in New Delhi on 7 October 2025. The agenda encompassed bilateral trade and investment relationships, alongside plans to broaden the India-Mercosur preferential trade agreement.

The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) successfully conducted the 10th National Level Pollution Response Exercise (NATPOLREX-X) along with the 27th National Oil Spill Disaster Contingency Plan (NOSDCP) and Preparedness Meeting off the coast of Chennai, Tamil Nadu, on October 5-6. The large-scale biennial exercise reaffirmed India's commitment to safeguarding its marine environment and strengthening inter-agency coordination for effective oil spill management.



Union Minister of Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal launched India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) at the Lulu Mall in Doha on 6 October 2025. This marking a new milestone in digital and financial cooperation between India and Qatar.



Shubhanshu Shukla, the first Indian to reach the International Space Station (ISS), was appointed as the brand ambassador for the "Viksit Bharat Buildathon" on 5 October 2025. The initiative is a nationwide innovation movement aimed at students from classes 6-12.

♦ The hackathon is being organized by the Ministry of Education in collaboration with Atal Innovation Mission.



The 12th edition of the World Para Athletics Championships concluded on 5 October 2025. The event, which began on September 26 at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, New Delhi, India, was the first-ever World Para Athletics Championships hosted by any South Asian country.

♦ India finished the championships in 10th spot in the standings with 22 medals - six gold, nine silver and seven bronze.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has unveiled various youth-focused initiatives worth over Rs.62,000 crore on 4 October 2025. He launched PM-SETU (Prime Minister's Skill and Employment Transformation through Advanced ITIs), a centrally sponsored scheme with an investment of Rs.60,000 crore.



The Border Roads Organisation (BRO) has achieved a new milestone by constructing the world's highest motorable road at Mig La Pass in eastern Ladakh, situated at an altitude of 19,400 feet. The feat surpasses the BRO's own previous record at Umling La (19,024 feet) and marks another breakthrough in India's high-altitude infrastructure drive.

The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) commissioned Ship Akshar, the second of eight Adamy-class Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs), at Karaikal, Puducherry on 4 October 2025. This 51-meter FPV has been designed with over 60 percent indigenous content.





Mirabai Chanu clinched a silver medal in the women's 48kg category at the World Weightlifting Championships 2025 in Forde, Norway, on 3 October 2025. Chanu lifted a total of 199kg including 84kg snatch + 115kg clean and jerk to secure second place overall.

This marked Chanu's first World Championship since 2022 and her second competition since finishing fourth at the Paris 2024 Olympics.

Union Minister for Electronics and Information Technology, Ashwini Vaishnaw launched the NIELIT Digital University (NDU) on 2 October 2025. This platform aimed at democratizing access to high-quality digital education in emerging technologies.



■ The platform, inaugurated at a national event in New Delhi, is designed to offer industry-aligned programmes in key areas such as Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity, Data Science, Semiconductors, and allied fields.

Union Minister for Youth Affairs & Sports and Labour & Employment Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya launched the MY Bharat Mobile Application on 1 October 2025, to strengthen youth engagement and leadership through technology.

■ Developed by the Digital India Corporation (DIC) under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), the app is part of the MY Bharat platform.

GST collections climbed to Rs.1.89 lakh crore in 2025 September, marking a 9.1 percent (Rs.1.73 lakh crore) increase from the year-ago period (2024 September). It is to be noted that GST 2.0 reforms in the form of rate rationalisation, which came into force on September 22, have been reflected in the collections.

Eminent Hindustani classical vocalist and Padma Bhushan awardee Pandit Chhannulal Mishra passed away in Uttar Pradesh on 2 October 2025.



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Asheesh Pandey assumed charge as Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of state-run Union Bank of India for a period of three years on 30 September 2025. He most recently served as executive director at Bank of Maharashtra for nearly four years. Before that, Pandey was chief general manager and chief operating officer at Union Bank.



Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri held consultations with his Bhutanese counterpart Aum Pema Choden in New Delhi on 29 September 2025. India announced two new rail links - Kokrajhar-Gelephu (Assam) and Banarhat-Samtse (West Bengal) - between India and Bhutan at a cost of Rs.4,033 crore.

The Border Security Force (BSF) unveiled Decision Support System (DSS) designed to enhance decision making capability of Commanders at all levels. The new system will help commanders to plan and execute operations based on informed decision-making through role-based access of the system via custom designed dashboards.

The International Cricket Council and UNICEF have joined hands to amplify the Promise to Children digital campaign during the ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025 to be played in India and Sri Lanka.

India has been re-elected to Part II of the Council of the International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) for the 2025–2028 term. The elections were conducted during the 42nd ICAO Assembly Session in Montreal, Canada.



INDIAN BIOSPHERE RESERVES IN UNESCO'S WNBR:

YEAR OF RECOGNITION	BIOSPHERE RESERVE	STATE(S) 
2000	Nilgiri	Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka
2001	Sundarbans	West Bengal
2001	Gulf of Mannar	Tamil Nadu
2004	Nanda Devi	Uttarakhand
2009	Nokrek	Meghalaya
2009	Similipal	Odisha
2009	Pachmarhi	Madhya Pradesh
2012	Achanakmar-Amarkantak	Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh
2013	Great Nicobar	Andaman & Nicobar Islands
2016	Agasthyamalai	Kerala, Tamil Nadu
2018	Khangchendzonga	Sikkim
2020	Panna	Madhya Pradesh
2025	Cold Desert	Himachal Pradesh